

Class #4 - Solution Set of a system

1. Fill in the blanks: A system of linear equations is consistent if and only if an echelon form of its _____ matrix does _____ have a row of the form

$$\begin{bmatrix} 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & \square \end{bmatrix}.$$

2. Existence and Uniqueness Theorem:

A linear system is consistent if and only if the rightmost column of the *augmented* matrix is _____ a pivot column.

If a linear system is consistent, then the solution set contains either

- (a) a unique solution, when there are no _____ variables (that is, every column *except* the rightmost column is a _____ column, or
 - (b) infinitely many solutions, when there is at least one free variable.
3. Example: Find the general solution of the linear system whose augmented matrix has been reduced to

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 6 & 2 & -5 & -2 & -4 \\ 0 & 0 & 2 & -8 & -1 & 3 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 7 \end{bmatrix}.$$

This requires a back-substitution to find a solution.

Its reduced echelon form is:

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 6 & 0 & 3 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 1 & -4 & 0 & 5 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 1 & 7 \end{bmatrix}.$$

In this case, the solution can be read off.

4. Def: Let A, B be sets. A rule that assigns exactly _____ element in B for _____ element in A is called a *function (or Transformation or Mapping)* from A to (or into) B .

We write

$$f : A \rightarrow B$$

to mean that f is a function from A into B .

The set A is called the _____ of f , and B is called the _____ of f .

5. Def: For an $x \in A$, $f(x)$ is called the _____ of x under f .

The *Range* of f is the set of all _____ as x varies over the set A :

$$\text{Range}(f) := \{f(x) \in \text{_____} : x \in \text{_____}\}.$$

6. Recall $\mathbf{R}^n$: _____, where n is a _____ number.

This ordered n -tuple of real numbers $(u_1, u_2, \dots, u_n)$ _____ called a *row-vector*.

The same thing written in columns

$$\begin{bmatrix} u_1 \\ u_2 \\ \vdots \\ u_n \end{bmatrix}$$

is called a _____ vector or just a vector. So,

$$\mathbf{R}^n = \{(u_1, u_2, \dots, u_n) : u_i \in \mathbf{R}\} = \left\{ \begin{bmatrix} u_1 \\ u_2 \\ \vdots \\ u_n \end{bmatrix} : u_i \in \mathbf{R} \right\}.$$

7. Def: The vector $\begin{bmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ \vdots \\ 0 \end{bmatrix}$ is called the _____ vector in $\mathbf{R}^n$.

Example: Given a nonzero vector in $\mathbf{R}^5$: _____.